

ALEXANDER J. WHITTAKER

San Francisco, CA • (555) 012-3456 • alex.whittaker@email.com
linkedin.com/in/alexwhittaker • github.com/awhittaker-dev

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Strategic and results-driven Senior Software Engineer with over 8 years of experience in architecting, developing, and deploying high-scale distributed systems and cloud-native applications. Expert in modern JavaScript ecosystems (React, Node.js), Python backend services, and robust DevOps practices. Proven track record of leading cross-functional teams to deliver enterprise-grade software that scales to millions of users. Specialized in transitioning legacy monoliths to microservices, optimizing database performance, and implementing CI/CD pipelines that reduce deployment time by over 60%. A passionate mentor committed to fostering a culture of technical excellence and continuous improvement.

CORE COMPETENCIES & TECHNICAL EXPERTISE

- **Languages:** JavaScript (ES6+), TypeScript, Python, Go, Java, SQL, HTML5, CSS3/SASS.
- **Frontend:** React.js, Redux, Next.js, Vue.js, Webpack, Tailwind CSS, Jest, Cypress.
- **Backend:** Node.js (Express/NestJS), Django, Flask, FastAPI, Spring Boot, GraphQL, RESTful APIs.
- **Cloud & DevOps:** AWS (EC2, S3, Lambda, RDS, EKS), Docker, Kubernetes, Terraform, Jenkins, GitHub Actions.
- **Databases:** PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Redis, Cassandra, DynamoDB, Elasticsearch.
- **Methodologies:** Agile/Scrum, Test-Driven Development (TDD), CI/CD, Microservices, Domain-Driven Design (DDD).

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Staff Software Engineer | GlobalTech Solutions | San Francisco, CA

January 2021 – Present

- **Architectural Leadership:** Led the architectural redesign of the flagship SaaS platform, migrating a monolithic Ruby on Rails application to a distributed microservices architecture using Node.js and Go.
- **Scalability Improvements:** Optimized data ingestion pipelines processing 500GB+ of daily telemetry data, reducing latency by 45% through the implementation of Apache Kafka and specialized Redis caching layers.
- **Team Mentorship:** Directly manage a team of 12 engineers; established a peer-review protocol that decreased production bugs by 30% within the first six months.
- **Cost Optimization:** Spearheaded a cloud-cost initiative on AWS, utilizing Spot Instances and Lambda functions for non-critical workloads, resulting in an annual saving of \$1.2M.
- **Security Integration:** Integrated OAuth2/OIDC protocols and implemented automated vulnerability scanning (Snyk) into the build pipeline, ensuring 100% compliance with SOC2 standards.
- **API Strategy:** Developed a public-facing GraphQL API that enabled third-party integrations, increasing platform adoption by 25% year-over-year.

Lead Full Stack Developer | Innovate Financial | New York, NY

June 2018 – December 2020

- **Full Stack Development:** Spearheaded the development of a high-frequency trading dashboard using React and WebSockets, supporting real-time data updates for 50,000+ concurrent users.
- **Performance Tuning:** Improved frontend rendering performance by 50% by implementing code-splitting, lazy loading, and optimizing heavy React component trees.
- **Database Management:** Migrated legacy MySQL databases to PostgreSQL, designing complex schemas and optimizing queries to handle millions of transactions per second.
- **Automated Testing:** Built a comprehensive testing suite achieving 95% code coverage using Jest and React Testing Library, significantly reducing regression issues.
- **Collaboration:** Worked closely with UI/UX designers to implement a custom Design System, ensuring visual consistency across five separate product lines.

Software Engineer II | CloudScale Systems | Austin, TX

September 2015 – May 2018

- **Backend Engineering:** Developed scalable RESTful APIs using Python/Django to support a mobile application with 1M+ active downloads.
- **Infrastructure as Code:** Authored Terraform scripts to automate the provisioning of multi-region AWS environments, reducing manual setup time from days to minutes.
- **Monitoring & Logging:** Implemented ELK Stack (Elasticsearch, Logstash, Kibana) for centralized logging and Prometheus/Grafana for real-time system monitoring.
- **Agile Participation:** Acted as Scrum Master for a pod of 6, facilitating daily standups, sprint planning, and retrospectives to maintain a high velocity.

PROJECT PORTFOLIO

Open Source Contributor | React Query & Next.js

- Contributed performance optimizations to the core caching logic of React Query, specifically regarding hydration in SSR environments.
- Authored documentation and examples for Next.js middleware implementation patterns.

Lead Architect | "SecureLink" P2P Encryption Tool

- Developed an open-source end-to-end encrypted file sharing service using WebRTC and the SubtleCrypto API.
- Implemented a zero-knowledge architecture ensuring that the server never has access to unencrypted user data.

DETAILED PROJECT CASE STUDIES

Case Study: Legacy Modernization at GlobalTech

The Challenge: The existing platform was a 10-year-old monolith that took 45 minutes to build and was prone to cascading failures. Scalability was capped by a single massive database instance.

The Solution:

- **Strategy:** Adopted a "Strangler Fig" pattern to gradually replace monolithic functionalities with independent services.
- **Execution:** Introduced an API Gateway (Kong) to manage traffic and versioning. Rewrote the authentication module first to support cross-service identity.
- **Result:** Build times reduced to 4 minutes. System uptime increased to 99.99%. Successfully handled a 4x traffic spike during a national marketing event without manual intervention.

Case Study: Real-Time Analytics Engine

The Challenge: Financial traders needed sub-second latency on market trend analysis, which the existing batch-processing system could not provide.

The Solution:

- **Technology:** Leveraged Apache Flink for stream processing and TimescaleDB for time-series data storage.
- **Implementation:** Built a custom WebSocket server in Go to push updates to the client-side React application.
- **Result:** Achieved an end-to-end latency of <200ms, enabling traders to make decisions on live data, leading to a 15% increase in trade volume.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

Education

Master of Science in Computer Science

Stanford University | 2015

Specialization: Distributed Systems and Artificial Intelligence

Bachelor of Science in Software Engineering

University of Texas at Austin | 2013

Graduated Magna Cum Laude

Professional Certifications

- AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Professional
- Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA)
- Google Professional Cloud Architect
- Oracle Certified Professional, Java SE Programmer

THOUGHT LEADERSHIP & SPEAKING

- **Speaker:** "Scaling Microservices with Go and Kubernetes" – QCon San Francisco, 2022.
- **Author:** Published "The Pragmatic Architect" series on Medium, reaching 100k+ readers.
- **Workshop Lead:** Conducted a 3-day intensive on "Advanced React Patterns" for internal engineering teams.

ADDITIONAL TECHNICAL DETAILS (DEEP DIVE)

Infrastructure & Systems Design

Experienced in designing highly available systems across multiple AWS availability zones. Proficient in:

- **Load Balancing:** ALB, NLB, and Route53 configuration for global traffic management.

- **Container Orchestration:** Deep knowledge of Kubernetes objects (Deployments, Services, Ingress, ConfigMaps, Secrets).
- **Service Mesh:** Implementation of Istio for mutual TLS, traffic splitting, and observability.

Backend Logic & Data Persistence

- **Query Optimization:** Expert in EXPLAIN ANALYZE for PostgreSQL, index tuning, and partitioning.
- **NoSQL Patterns:** Designed document schemas for MongoDB and wide-column models for Cassandra to support horizontal scaling.
- **Concurrency:** Skilled in handling race conditions, distributed locking (using Redis/Redlock), and idempotent API design.

Frontend Engineering Standards

- **State Management:** Comparative expertise in Redux Toolkit, MobX, and React Context API.
- **Testing Pyramid:** Implementation of E2E (Playwright), Integration (Jest), and Unit testing.
- **Web Performance:** Expertise in Core Web Vitals, tree-shaking, and image optimization techniques.

SOFT SKILLS & MANAGEMENT

- **Strategic Planning:** Collaborating with Product Managers to define technical roadmaps.
- **Conflict Resolution:** Facilitating technical debates and ensuring alignment on architecture.
- **Hiring:** Conducted over 200 technical interviews; developed the standard "System Design" interview rubric for GlobalTech.

INDUSTRY CONTRIBUTIONS

- **Mentorship:** Volunteer mentor for "Code2040", supporting underrepresented groups in tech.
- **Open Source:** Maintained several NPM packages with combined 10k+ weekly downloads.
- **Advisory:** Technical advisor for two Series A startups in the FinTech space.

SUMMARY OF EXPERIENCE BY YEAR

- **2015-2016:** Focus on Python, Scripting, and Basic Cloud services.
- **2017-2018:** Transition to full-stack roles, Docker, and CI/CD mastery.
- **2019-2020:** Lead roles, focusing on architectural patterns and high-performance React.
- **2021-Present:** Executive leadership, multi-cloud strategy, and organizational-scale engineering.